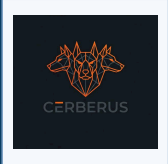


COT Positioning Extremes



INTERNAL

Use CFTC net positioning z-scores to identify crowded trades.

Author: Cerberus Research

Generated: 2026-08-07 08:47 UTC

N
3,502

CLASSIFICATION internal	AUTHOR Cerberus Research
RUN ID 20260807_094714	GIT COMMIT 978cf61e
DURATION 0.6s	DATASETS cot/cot_curated
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N 3,502	

KEY FINDINGS - Markets analysed: 24 Extreme events ($z \geq 2.0$): 314 - EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE (fx_majors): $z=-2.60$ net=-72447 long=204975 short=277422 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00 - DJIA Consolidated - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE (equity_indexes): $z=+2.50$ net=19563 long=25899 short=6336 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00

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- 02 Results & Interpretation
- 03 Key Findings
- 04 Data Sources
- 05 Objectives
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- 09 Limitations

Generated by the Cerberus studies framework · schema 2

Data Sources

- cot/cot_curated

Key Findings

- Markets analysed: 24 | Extreme events ($|z| \geq 2.0$): 314
- EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE (fx_majors): $z=-2.60$ net=-72447 long=204975 short=277422 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00
- DJIA Consolidated - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE (equity_indexes): $z=+2.50$ net=19563 long=25899 short=6336 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00
- DJIA x \$5 - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE (equity_indexes): $z=+2.29$ net=16339 long=25463 short=9124 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00
- MICRO E-MINI DJIA (x\$0.5) - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE (equity_indexes): $z=+2.20$ net=32238 long=37520 short=5282 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00
- E-MINI S&P 500 - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE (equity_indexes): $z=+2.20$ net=-17196 long=257703 short=274899 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00

Executive Summary

NOTE

Uses CFTC Commitment of Traders net positioning z-scores, computed per market, to identify crowded positioning extremes with long/short position context.

Results & Interpretation

NOTE

Use CFTC net positioning z-scores to identify crowded trades.

The study analysed 3,502 rows of data.

Main takeaways:

- Markets analysed: 24 | Extreme events ($|z| \geq 2.0$): 314
- EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE (fx_majors): $z=-2.60$ net=-72447 long=204975 short=277422 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00
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- DJIA x \$5 - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE (equity_indexes): $z=+2.29$ net=16339 long=25463 short=9124 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00

· MICRO E-MINI DJIA (x\$0.5) - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE (equity_indexes): $z=+2.20$ net=32238
long=37520 short=5282 as of 2026-07-28 00:00:00+00:00

Objectives

NOTE

Evaluate whether the studied signal produces a measurable, repeatable edge.

Quantify the reliability of the observed patterns across the sample.

Methodology

NOTE

Analysis is run on the configured datasets with the parameters listed in the Study Configuration block. Results are aggregated into summary statistics, tables, and visual one-pagers for review.

Charts



Figure 1. COT net positioning z-scores by market (52-week rolling)

COT net positioning z-scores by market (52-week rolling)

Statistical Results

market	asset_cl...	repor...	long_p...	short_p...	open_i...	net_p...	net_...	z_s...	crowdi...	concentrat...
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-07-28	204,975	277,422	819,806	-72,447	-0.09	-2.60	True	False
DJIA Consolidated - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	25,899	6,336	87,436	19,563	+ 0.22	2.50	True	False
DJIA x \$5 - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	25,463	9,124	83,013	16,339	+ 0.20	2.29	True	False
MICRO E-MINI DJIA (x\$0.5) - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	37,520	5,282	44,234	32,238	+ 0.73	2.20	True	False
E-MINI S&P 500 - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	257,703	274,899	1,984,408	-17,196	-0.01	2.20	True	False
S&P 500 Consolidated - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	252,526	271,611	2,007,178	-19,085	-0.01	2.17	True	False
MICRO E-MINI NASDAQ-100 INDEX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	61,969	210,250	249,950	-148,281	-0.59	-1.80	False	False
RUSSELL 2000 ANNUAL DIVIDEND - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	17,894	17,234	44,565	660	+ 0.01	-1.75	False	True
S&P 500 ANNUAL DIVIDEND INDEX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	145,654	62,705	386,505	82,949	+ 0.21	-1.64	False	False
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-07-28	101,271	264,683	432,366	-163,412	-0.38	-1.60	False	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-07-28	10,117	43,579	111,939	-33,462	-0.30	1.50	False	False
WTI FINANCIAL CRUDE OIL - NEW YORK MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	crude_oil	2026-07-28	47,887	28,129	212,110	19,758	+ 0.09	-1.30	False	True
NASDAQ-100 Consolidated - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	67,927	77,841	319,776	-9,914	-0.03	-1.24	False	False
EURO FX/JAPANESE YEN XRATE - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-07-28	6,377	3,791	21,567	2,586	+ 0.12	1.18	False	True
S&P 500 QUARTERLY DIVIDEND IND - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	23,583	16,381	42,012	7,202	+ 0.17	1.17	False	True
MICRO E-MINI S&P 500 INDEX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	78,193	97,077	227,701	-18,884	-0.08	-1.16	False	False

Research only. Not investment advice. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

market	asset_cl...	repor...	long_p...	short_p...	open_i...	net_p...	net_...	z_s...	crowdi...	concentrat...
ADJUSTED INT RATE S&P 500 TOTL - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	76,102	114,797	1,023,158	-38,695	-0.04	-1.08	False	False
MICRO GOLD - COMMODITY EXCHANGE INC.	gold	2026-07-28	35,779	46,335	83,553	-10,556	-0.13	0.84	False	False
BRITISH POUND - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-07-28	61,458	126,272	267,426	-64,814	-0.24	-0.68	False	False
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2026-07-28	87,185	83,212	781,193	3,973	+ 0.01	-0.45	False	False

Table 1. Latest COT positioning by market (sorted by |z|)

market	asset_class	report_d...	net_positi...	net_pct_oi	z_score	crowding_flag
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2025-11-04	62,350	+ 0.08	2.25	True
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2025-12-09	74,535	+ 0.10	2.45	True
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2026-03-17	-32,831	-0.04	-2.02	True
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2026-03-24	-36,282	-0.04	-2.05	True
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2026-03-31	-45,002	-0.05	-2.15	True
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-16	-36,212	-0.39	-2.12	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-23	-42,562	-0.44	-2.50	True
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-30	-41,786	-0.42	-2.13	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-05-07	-41,787	-0.44	-2.17	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-05-14	-41,107	-0.45	-2.14	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2025-06-10	-21,268	-0.24	2.26	True
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2025-12-23	-43,989	-0.50	-2.32	True
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2025-12-30	-44,198	-0.50	-2.13	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2023-12-26	-55,568	-0.29	2.12	False

Research only. Not investment advice. Past performance is not indicative of future results.

market	asset_class	report_d...	net_positi...	net_pct_oi	z_score	crowding_flag
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-01-09	-55,949	-0.28	2.10	False
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-01-16	-56,560	-0.27	2.16	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-09	-162,151	-0.50	-2.31	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-16	-165,619	-0.50	-2.15	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-23	-179,919	-0.54	-2.53	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-07-30	-73,460	-0.24	2.15	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-08-06	-11,354	-0.04	4.02	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-08-13	23,104	+ 0.07	4.20	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-08-20	23,585	+ 0.07	3.57	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-08-27	25,868	+ 0.08	3.17	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-09-03	41,116	+ 0.13	3.08	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-09-10	55,770	+ 0.15	2.88	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-09-17	56,840	+ 0.28	3.21	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-09-24	66,011	+ 0.32	3.00	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-10-01	56,772	+ 0.29	2.61	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-10-08	36,528	+ 0.19	2.02	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-01-13	-45,164	-0.15	-2.42	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-01-20	-44,829	-0.15	-2.36	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-01-27	-33,933	-0.11	-2.06	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-03-17	-67,780	-0.21	-2.05	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-04-07	-93,742	-0.27	-2.01	True

market	asset_class	report_d...	net_positi...	net_pct_oi	z_score	crowding_flag
EURO FX/BRITISH POUND XRATE - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-06-18	-9,740	-0.38	-2.74	True
EURO FX/BRITISH POUND XRATE - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-06-25	-10,537	-0.40	-2.71	True
EURO FX/BRITISH POUND XRATE - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-07-02	-11,477	-0.42	-2.67	True
EURO FX/BRITISH POUND XRATE - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-07-09	-10,191	-0.38	-2.15	True
EURO FX/BRITISH POUND XRATE - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-07-23	-10,667	-0.39	-2.05	True
EURO FX/BRITISH POUND XRATE - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-08-06	-13,065	-0.46	-2.41	True
EURO FX/BRITISH POUND XRATE - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2025-03-25	-1,481	-0.05	2.02	True
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-02-06	62,153	+ 0.08	-2.06	True
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-02-13	52,838	+ 0.07	-2.19	True
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-03-26	31,194	+ 0.05	-2.13	True
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-02	16,794	+ 0.02	-2.38	True
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-16	12,224	+ 0.02	-2.21	True
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-23	-9,989	-0.02	-2.55	True
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-30	-6,777	-0.01	-2.29	True
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-10-22	-28,524	-0.04	-2.04	True

Table 2. Positioning extremes ($|z| \geq \text{threshold}$)

Limitations

NOTE

Results are research-grade, not investment advice. The sample is limited to available data, and measured edges may not persist out-of-sample.

Appendix Tables

extremes

market	asset_class	report_d...	net_positi...	net_pct_oi	z_score	crowding_flag
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2025-11-04	62,350	+ 0.08	2.25	True
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2025-12-09	74,535	+ 0.10	2.45	True
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2026-03-17	-32,831	-0.04	-2.02	True
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2026-03-24	-36,282	-0.04	-2.05	True
CRUDE OIL, LIGHT SWEET-WTI - ICE FUTURES EUROPE	crude_oil	2026-03-31	-45,002	-0.05	-2.15	True
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-16	-36,212	-0.39	-2.12	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-23	-42,562	-0.44	-2.50	True
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-04-30	-41,786	-0.42	-2.13	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-05-07	-41,787	-0.44	-2.17	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-05-14	-41,107	-0.45	-2.14	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2025-06-10	-21,268	-0.24	2.26	True
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2025-12-23	-43,989	-0.50	-2.32	True
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2025-12-30	-44,198	-0.50	-2.13	True
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2023-12-26	-55,568	-0.29	2.12	False
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2024-01-09	-55,949	-0.28	2.10	False

market_latest

market	asset_cl...	repor...	long_p...	short_p...	open_i...	net_p...	net_...	z_s...	crowdi...	concentrat...
EURO FX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-07-28	204,975	277,422	819,806	-72,447	-0.09	-2.60	True	False
DJIA Consolidated - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	25,899	6,336	87,436	19,563	+ 0.22	2.50	True	False
DJIA x \$5 - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	25,463	9,124	83,013	16,339	+ 0.20	2.29	True	False

market	asset_cl...	repor...	long_p...	short_p...	open_i...	net_p...	net_...	z_s...	crowdi...	concentrat...
MICRO E-MINI DJIA (x\$0.5) - CHICAGO BOARD OF TRADE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	37,520	5,282	44,234	32,238	+ 0.73	2.20	True	False
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S&P 500 Consolidated - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	252,526	271,611	2,007,178	-19,085	-0.01	2.17	True	False
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S&P 500 ANNUAL DIVIDEND INDEX - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	145,654	62,705	386,505	82,949	+ 0.21	-1.64	False	False
JAPANESE YEN - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-07-28	101,271	264,683	432,366	-163,412	-0.38	-1.60	False	False
SWISS FRANC - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	fx_majors	2026-07-28	10,117	43,579	111,939	-33,462	-0.30	1.50	False	False
WTI FINANCIAL CRUDE OIL - NEW YORK MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	crude_oil	2026-07-28	47,887	28,129	212,110	19,758	+ 0.09	-1.30	False	True
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S&P 500 QUARTERLY DIVIDEND IND - CHICAGO MERCANTILE EXCHANGE	equity_indexes	2026-07-28	23,583	16,381	42,012	7,202	+ 0.17	1.17	False	True

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Statistics Summary

Key	Value
study	cot_positioning_extreme
category	macro
status	success
parameters	{'lookback_files': 60, 'horizon': 21, 'z_threshold': 2.0}
datasets	['cot/cot_curated']
rows	3502
git_commit	978cf61eefd9b125a5087073e70ef1c9d91f687b
executed_at	2026-08-07T08:47:14.851234+00:00

Glossary

Term	Definition
n / count	Number of observations or events in the sample.
edge	Average excess return versus the unconditional baseline.
hit-rate	Share of events with a positive forward return.
p-value	Probability of observing the result under the null of no edge.
*** / ** / *	Significance at 99.9% / 99% / 95% confidence.
α (alpha)	Intercept or active return versus benchmark.
β (beta)	Sensitivity to a reference factor or market.
σ (sigma)	Volatility / standard deviation of returns.

Document Control

Field	Value
Report schema	2
Framework version	0.1.0
Classification	internal
Generated	2026-08-07 08:47 UTC
Author	Cerberus Research
Study slug	cot_positioning_extreme
Run ID	20260807_094714
Git commit	978cf61e
Datasets	cot/cot_curated

Field	Value
Parameters hash	bb63fb695717
Parameter · lookback_files	60
Parameter · horizon	21
Parameter · z_threshold	2
Data fingerprint	635bdcfc6680
Duration	0.6s